then state BJP secretary Kailash Sarang. This was a state where the Jan Sangh had grown deep early roots.[28]

Eventually, a novel compromise was worked out. Scindia was prevailed upon to publicly withdraw her dissent note on the adoption of ‘socialism’ as party ideology. In a hurriedly organised press conference, she announced that she had done so after the party’s senior leaders explained to her that the BJP’s socialism actually had an ‘Indian content’, unlike that of Karl Marx. She said she had changed her mind after it was explained to her that the ‘socialism’ the party was adopting was actually the ‘jan-kalyanwad’ of Indian tradition and the ‘integral humanism’ advocated by Deendayal Upadhyaya.[29] When Madhya Pradesh leader Bhai Mahavir’s attempts to bring around other dissidents failed, Vajpayee himself intervened, declaring that the party ‘will not go back on Gandhian socialism’. After this, the resolution on adopting Gandhian socialism as a founding ideology was voted in with overwhelming support.[30]

Narendra Modi’s appropriation of Gandhi’s imagery draws from, and builds on, this earlier history. An image depicting the Mahatma’s spectacles was adopted as the official logo of the Swachh Bharat Mission (launched on the Mahatma’s birth anniversary in 2014 for a five-year drive until his 150th birth anniversary in 2019).[31] Earlier, in 2010-11, as Gujarat chief minister, Modi had led a move to build a large Mahatma Mandir Convention Centre in the state capital of Gandhinagar. He also led an initiative where representatives of all 18,066 villages in Gujarat would bring sand in urns and empty them into the foundation of the Mahatma Mandir. This Convention Centre included a memorial to Gandhi’s Dandi March and a large charkha (spinning wheel) installation. A special road was built connecting the Mahatma Mandir with the Gujarat Legislative Assembly building.[32] The resistance by a section of the party in that first plenary session of 1980 to adopting Gandhian nomenclature seemed like something from the distant past.

Another much-commented on sign of internal discord in 1980 was the absence of former RSS pracharak and senior Jan Sangh leader Nanaji Deshmukh at that plenary. Deshmukh was, at the time, considered one of the six leading lights of the Jan Sangh. He had